

Plant
collectors



Looking at plants

THERE ARE TWO TYPES of plant collection—living plants and preserved specimens. A herbarium is a collection of preserved specimens, usually pressed, that can be examined by botanists. Collections of living plants are equally important and sometimes ensure that rare plant species do not die out. Making your own collection of flowers and pressing them is a good way to learn about plants. However, you should not pick flowers that are growing wild in the countryside, since this prevents them from producing seeds. All wild flower species are protected by law, and you must not uproot them without receiving permission from the person who owns the land. If you want to try to grow your own plants, you can collect small amounts of seed, or you can buy wild flower seeds produced by plants that have been raised in nurseries. Growing your own plants gives you a chance to study them without harming plants in the wild.



Herbarium
specimen
sheet

Preserving
bottle



Box
containing
dried specimen



Plant press



BOTANIST'S COLLECTING EQUIPMENT
When collecting plants for the herbarium, a specimen is pressed and then mounted on a herbarium sheet with a label saying where and when it was found. The herbarium sheet can then be consulted by botanists wishing to study the plant in detail.



Pruning
shears



Trowel